

Cristian Navarro

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Political Economy, Economic History  
Secondary: Development Economics

EDUCATION

|                                                                     |             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Ph.D. in Economics (Cum Laude, International Doctorate Distinction) | 2022 – 2026 |
| Centro de Estudios Monetarios y Financieros (CEMFI)                 |             |
| Visiting Scholar                                                    | Spring 2025 |
| Uppsala University – Sponsor: Luca Repetto                          |             |
| M.Sc. in Economics and Finance                                      | 2020 – 2022 |
| Centro de Estudios Monetarios y Financieros (CEMFI)                 |             |
| M.Sc. in Economics                                                  | 2018 – 2020 |
| Universitat de Barcelona                                            |             |
| Erasmus+ Exchange – University of Copenhagen (Fall 2020)            |             |
| B.A. in Economics                                                   | 2012 – 2016 |
| Universitat de Barcelona                                            |             |

REFERENCES

|                         |                    |                    |                        |
|-------------------------|--------------------|--------------------|------------------------|
| Carlos Sanz             | Samuel Bentolila   | Tom Zohar          | Luca Repetto           |
| Bank of Spain and CEMFI | CEMFI              | CEMFI              | Uppsala University     |
| carlossanz@bde.es       | bentolila@cemfi.es | tom.zohar@cemfi.es | luca.repetto@nek.uu.se |

PUBLICATIONS

“Personalized Employment Support for the Homeless: Evidence from a Randomized Evaluation” (with Miguel Almunia and Begoña Varela Merino) - *SERIEs – Journal of the Spanish Economic Association (accepted)*.

Comentado [CN1]: DOI: 10.1007/s13209-026-00344-1

WORKING PAPERS

“Autocrats Remake the State: Evidence from Francoist Spain”, with Ricard Grebol – *Job Market Paper*  
In autocracies, personnel decisions often prioritize ideological alignment over merit. We investigate how such ideology-based personnel selection shapes the quality of the public workforce and its implications for state capacity. We examine this in the context of a large-scale political purge and reorganization of primary school teachers carried out by the Francoist dictatorship following the Spanish Civil War (1936-1939). We construct a novel dataset linking newly digitized purge archives and administrative records that track teacher careers, and document that more competent teachers were disproportionately dismissed and that average experience declined by about 2.6 years (14.4%). Local shortages created by the purge were partly offset by regime efforts to reassign teachers across municipalities, yet coordination frictions in this process left persistent staffing deficits that spread to areas less affected by the purge. Our findings show how ideology-based personnel reforms can erode public workforce expertise and weaken the state’s capacity to deliver essential services, providing a mechanism through which autocratic consolidation entails sizable capacity costs.

“Seeds of Prejudice: The impact of British colonization on attitudes towards sexual minorities”, with Alexandros Cavgias – *Submitted*  
CEMFI Working Paper Series 2514 – IDEAS/RePEc WP 25/1117  
This paper provides the first causal test of the hypothesis that British colonial institutions promoted sexual prejudice in postcolonial societies. OLS estimates across former European colonies show higher sexual prejudice in former British colonies than in those of other European powers, conditional on contemporary economic development. Geo-RDD estimates similarly show significantly higher sexual prejudice in former British than Portuguese colonies in Southern and Eastern Africa, where local norms did not systematically condemn same-sex relations. Evidence from South America and Southeast Asia reveals the same pattern. By contrast, British and French colonies display similar levels of sexual prejudice in Western Africa, where non-colonial religious norms condemning same-sex acts are more prevalent. Mechanisms analysis suggests that exposure to alien social norms through colonial legislation is the key mechanism linking British colonial institutions to contemporary sexual prejudice. Overall, our results indicate that British colonialism increased sexual prejudice where social norms differed from colonizers’ penal codes.

## WORK IN PROGRESS

“Ballot measures, political advertising, and contribution caps”, with Pello Aspuru  
“Why Inform? Ideology, Interest, and Animosity in Times of the Inquisition”, with Álvaro Sánchez-Leache  
“The Political and Economic Costs of Armed Nationalism: Evidence from ETA and the Basque Country”,  
with Ricard Grebol and Luca Repetto

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND SEMINAR (S)

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Universitat Rovira i Virgili (S), Universidad Pablo de Olavide (S), ICADE (S), 4 <sup>th</sup> Workshop in Economic History (Uppsala), 1 <sup>st</sup> Spanish Political Economy International Network (SPEIN) Workshop, 51 Simposio de la Asociación Española de Economía (scheduled) | 2026 |
| Uppsala University (S), 3 <sup>rd</sup> Workshop in Economic History (Uppsala), 3 <sup>rd</sup> Spanish Workshop in Development Economics, Madrid Empirical Social Sciences Conference                                                                                                 | 2025 |
| SITES-GLO Annual Conference, 2nd Spanish Workshop in Development Economics, 49 Simposio de la Asociación Española de Economía                                                                                                                                                          | 2024 |

## PRE-PHD PUBLICATIONS

“Globalisation and natural resource abundance. Is export diversification possible? A comparison of export composition in Chile and Norway, 1870-2017”, with Marc Badia-Miró, José Peres-Cajías and Anna Carreras Marin. *Natural Resources and Divergence: A Comparison of Andean and Nordic Trajectories*, 2021. Palgrave Macmillan. DOI: [10.1007/978-3-030-71044-6\\_2](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-71044-6_2)

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

|                                                                                        |                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| CEMFI, Visiting Researcher                                                             | June – July 2026 |
| CEMFI, Research Assistant for Professor Monica Martinez-Bravo (part-time)              | 2021 – 2023      |
| Universitat de Barcelona, Research Assistant for Professor Marc Badia-Miró (part-time) | 2018 – 2019      |

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

|                                                               |                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Uncertainty and Information (Microeconomics II)</b>        | Winter 2024, Winter 2025 |
| CEMFI – TA for Professor Guillermo Caruana                    |                          |
| <b>Markets and Organizations</b>                              | Spring 2023              |
| CEMFI – TA for Professor Guillermo Caruana and Wouter Vergote |                          |

## PREVIOUS WORKING EXPERIENCE

|                                                      |                     |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Sant Cugat del Vallès City Council – Project officer | Apr 2018 – Sep 2018 |
| PricewaterhouseCoopers – Business Consultant         | Aug 2016 – Apr 2018 |

## GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| CEMFI doctoral fellowship, María de Maeztu Unit of Excellence (MDM-2016-0684)                                  | 2022 – 2026 |
| Predctoral Fellowship for Doctoral Training (PRE2022-102202), Ministry of Science, Innovation and Universities | 2023 – 2026 |
| María de Maeztu Exploration grant (€7,500)                                                                     | 2024        |
| María de Maeztu Scholarship (M.Sc., MDM-2016-0684)                                                             | 2020 – 2022 |
| Extraordinary award for the MSc (Universitat de Barcelona)                                                     | 2020        |
| Fundació Catalunya La Pedrera Scholarship                                                                      | 2018 – 2020 |
| Extraordinary award for the B.A. (Universitat de Barcelona)                                                    | 2016        |

## OTHER INFORMATION

**Languages:** English (fluent), Catalan and Spanish (native)  
**Programming:** Stata, R, QGIS, Python, LaTeX  
**Citizenship:** Spanish